

AUBURN UNIVERSITY

College of Liberal Arts

PRINCIPLES OF MACROECONOMICS

ECON 2030, Fall 2026, Section 001

MWF 10:00 AM – 10:50 AM | Auburn Main Campus, Lowder Hall, Room 113A

Instructor Information

Professor	Yushang Wei
Office	Miller Hall 109D
E-Mail	Send all questions through the Canvas Inbox (Conversations). Address your message to Jafar Khaksar , our head GTA for the Fall 2026 semester, who will answer most of the questions a student may have about the class. If the head GTA cannot answer the question or assist with the issue, he will forward it to the professor. All messages will be answered within 48 hours. (See the “How to Message the GTA” page on Canvas for step-by-step directions.)
Help Sessions / Office Hours / Make-up Tests	TTH, 3:30–8:00 p.m. in Miller 201. Help sessions and office hours will be held by both graduate and undergraduate TAs. ALL make-up tests will also be administered on these two days during these specific hours.
MyEconLab (Pearson) Help	For help connecting to MyEconLab, use Pearson Student Support (https://support.pearson.com/getsupport/s/learners?language=en_US). During the first two weeks of the semester you may also drop in to Pearson Virtual Office Hours on Zoom (Aug 19, 21, 25 & 28, 11:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m.; Zoom Meeting ID 951 1374 6533). See the “Connect to Pearson” page on Canvas for the full Zoom link and setup steps.
Class Webpages	Canvas (https://auburn.instructure.com), MyEconLab (lectures, homeworks)

Course Description

This course covers the fundamentals of macroeconomics and provides insights into how an economy as a whole functions.

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing the course, students will be able to:

1. Compute basic indicators of economic performance, such as GDP, GDP per capita (both nominal and real), growth rates of GDP and GDP per capita, unemployment rate, and inflation rate;
2. Use graphs that they learn in this course to analyze major economic events;

3. Identify business cycles (recessions and booms) in the economy and analyze their causes using the AS–AD diagram;
4. Discuss different government policies (fiscal and monetary) and evaluate their effects on the economy;
5. Analyze and assess statements about the economy and major economic events in the media (TV, radio, newspapers, etc.) using concepts, formulas, and graphs that they learn in this course.

Instructional / Teaching Method

This is an in-person course that is delivered in a classroom over 16 weeks of instruction plus finals week. Canvas and MyEconLab will be used to post reading material, class notes, and assignments for this course. Students are responsible for checking both websites for information related to the course on a daily basis.

There will be three unit exams and an optional final in this class.

Course Requirements

- **Required:** E-textbook: *Macroeconomics*, 9th ed., R. Glenn Hubbard and Anthony P. O'Brien.
- **Required:** A MyEconLab account. MyEconLab can be accessed through Canvas (look for the “MyEconLab” tab on the left once you enter the course on Canvas). MyEconLab will be used to assign homeworks for each lecture. MyEconLab is now a part of AllAccess and students will be charged through e-bill for it (no need to pay with a credit card when registering).
- **Required:** A working computer and reliable internet connection, since all assignments will have to be done and submitted online.

Prerequisites

No formal prerequisite for this class.

Examinations

There will be 3 unit exams and an optional final. ALL exams are in-person and will be administered in our regular classroom (Lowder Hall, Room 113A).

Unit Exams

There are three units in this course, so there will be three unit exams. Each has around 30 multiple-choice questions and is designed to be completed within 50 minutes. Since economics is inherently cumulative, content from earlier exams may be on subsequent exams. However, the focus of each exam will be its associated unit. Unit exams will be held during the normal lecture time in the regular classroom (see the exam dates under “Other Important Dates”). You could bring a 1-page (only one side) cheat sheet (Letter size 8.5 by 11 inches), but it must be hand-written; internet-connected devices will not be allowed during exams.

Final Exam Retakes (Optional)

The final exam is your last chance to demonstrate your proficiency in the course material. It serves two purposes: it is a make-up for any missed unit exam, and it is an opportunity to retake unit exams for a higher grade. Taking the final is entirely optional.

You will know your current standing in the course (based on your exam scores so far) on the last day of class of the semester, *before* the optional retakes take place. You can then decide whether participating is

worthwhile: if you are satisfied with your course grade, you do not need to take the final exam. Before the final, I will post a survey asking whether you wish to participate.

Based on university policy, the final exam is scheduled for 2 hours. Because each unit exam takes about 50 minutes, this window gives you time to retake two of the three unit exams. If you missed a unit exam, you can make it up during this time, and if you want to improve your grade on any unit exam, you can retake it. You may attempt to retake all three unit exams within the 2-hour period, but I do not recommend it, as you would need to complete around 90 questions in that time. A retake replaces your original score on that unit exam *only if the retake score is higher*; a lower retake will not hurt your grade.

The cheat sheet allowance depends on how many exams you retake (all cheat sheets must be hand-written, letter size 8.5 by 11 inches):

- Retaking one unit exam: one page, single-sided (one side only).
- Retaking two unit exams: one page, double-sided (both sides may be used).
- Retaking all three unit exams: one page plus one side (a double-sided page plus one additional single side).

Exam Day Checklist

Before each exam, make sure you:

1. Arrive on time.
2. Bring a calculator (calculators are allowed).
3. Print your own bubble sheet — you can find the bubble sheet on Canvas.
4. Bring your Student ID.
5. Bring your cheat sheet.

Make-Up Exams

If a student misses a unit exam for a legitimate, documented reason, they may either take a make-up exam or do the final retakes.

Documentation is required for all excuses, and notification must be provided before the exam or, at the latest, on the day of the exam. If notification occurs afterward, the student must also provide a valid reason for the delay. Failure to do so will result in a ZERO. Fraudulent documentation will be treated as academic dishonesty and reported to the Dean of Students.

All make-up exams are administered during help sessions/office hours (see above). Students must bring a hard copy of their documentation to the make-up exam and a university ID. Per Auburn policy, make-ups must be completed within ONE week of the missed exam. To schedule a make-up test, students should submit a request to the head GTA via Canvas.

Bonuses

There are two ways to earn bonus points in this course. Each bonus point is worth 1% of your grade, and the total bonus that can be added to your course grade is capped at 5 points (5%) for the semester.

Method 1: In-Class Participation

During lectures we will have some in-class MyEconLab questions (these are separate from the graded MyEconLab homework). Participating in these earns bonus credit, and the in-class bonus is worth up to 5% in total. There is NO make-up for the in-class bonus: even if you are absent for a documented reason (for example, illness), you cannot make up missed in-class questions. However, you can still earn bonus by attending the homework help sessions (see Method 2).

Method 2: Help Sessions / Office Hours

You can get ONE bonus point for attending THREE help sessions/office hours held by graduate and undergraduate TAs. Help sessions are held for assistance with homeworks, class materials, preparing for exams, and reviewing exams.

How Bonuses Are Applied

You may use both methods, but the total bonus is capped at 5 bonus points (5%) for the semester. For example, if you earn 5% from in-class questions and 5% from help sessions, the total bonus added to your grade is still 5% (not 10%). Bonuses are added to your course grade at the very end, so it is possible to get up to 105% in the class. Bonuses can only raise your total course grade — you will NOT be penalized if you do not earn any bonuses throughout the semester (i.e., not having any bonuses will NOT lower your course grade).

MyEconLab Homeworks

Homeworks will be assigned on MyEconLab for every topic/lecture (note that most topics/lectures will take more than one class to finish). MyEconLab participation is required and will count for 24% of the course grade. **All homeworks/assignments are due on Monday, December 7, 2026 (the first day of finals week), at midnight. NO late submissions will be accepted.** MyEconLab homeworks will be very similar to problems that we solve in class. If a student experiences any kind of technical issue with their MyEconLab account, they need to get in touch with MyEconLab tech support immediately. The tech support will open a case file and send me a report about the issue. For assistance with MyEconLab homeworks and any class materials, students should attend help sessions/office hours held by GTAs and UTAs.

Academic Integrity

Acts of academic dishonesty will not be tolerated and will be met with swift justice. Please see the Auburn University Academic Integrity Policy (Title XII) found in the Tiger Cub.

Policy on Classroom Behavior

The goal of Auburn University and its faculty and students is to foster a dynamic environment of higher learning where all students develop analytical skills, learn to think critically, and communicate effectively, promote inquiry, pursue knowledge, and prepare for productive careers. Behavior in the classroom that impedes teaching and learning and creates obstacles to this goal is considered disruptive and therefore subject to sanctions. The purpose of these sanctions is to create and protect an optimum learning experience; they should not be considered punitive, neither by the student nor by the instructor. Disagreement expressed in a civil fashion, eccentricity, idiosyncrasy, and unconventional behavior are not, per se, disruptive to the classroom experience. These sanctions are intended only to preserve the classroom as a place to pursue knowledge, exchange ideas, and share opinions in an atmosphere of tolerance.

Students have the responsibility of complying with behavioral standards. Faculty members have a professional responsibility to set reasonable limits on the expression of opinions while treating students with dignity, respect, and understanding while guiding classroom activities. At the classroom level, clear guidelines for behavior and early intervention are the foundation for an intellectually stimulating experience for students and instructors alike. Instructors are encouraged to include in their syllabi guidelines for

classroom behavior. Instructors who state these guidelines early and enforce them at the first appearance of disruptive behavior prevent minor episodes of classroom misconduct from escalating into serious confrontations and help transgressors to avoid the more serious consequences of such actions.

Examples of improper behavior in the classroom (including the virtual classroom of e-mail, chat rooms, telephony, and web activities associated with courses) may include, but are not limited to, the following:

1. Arriving after a class has begun (if you are running late, please be quiet and find a seat without disturbing your classmates);
2. Use of tobacco products;
3. Monopolizing discussion;
4. Persistent speaking out of turn;
5. Distractive talking, including cell phone usage (please set cell phones and laptops to silent mode);
6. Audio or video recording of classroom activities or the use of electronic devices without the permission of the instructor;
7. Refusal to comply with reasonable instructor directions;
8. Employing insulting language or gestures;
9. Verbal, psychological, or physical threats, harassment, and physical violence;
10. Please avoid eating foods with strong odors during the lecture, as it can disturb your classmates. If you are really hungry, consider having an energy bar, candy, or chocolate instead. Any food that may disturb the study environment is not permitted.

When confronted with disruptive but non-threatening behavior, the instructor should issue a general word of caution to the class as a whole rather than to a particular student so as not to exacerbate the problem. If a general caution directed to the entire class does not stop the disruptive activity, the instructor should endeavor to meet in private with the disruptive student. The resulting discussion should include a description of the problem, the reason it is disruptive, and the consequences of continued violations of classroom behavior guidelines. If the disruptive behavior is preventing further instruction, the instructor is authorized to ask the disruptive student to leave the class immediately for the remainder of the class session.

Removal from the classroom for more than one class period, for an extended period, or on a permanent basis normally requires the instructor to file charges of a violation of the Auburn University Code of Student Conduct with the Vice President for Student Affairs. The department head/chair or dean may negotiate a withdrawal from the course or a transfer of the disruptive student to a different course section or course, if, in his or her opinion, a different instructor and different classmates would diffuse the situation and provide the disruptive student with a new learning opportunity. If threats have been made or physical violence is imminent, the instructor should notify the Auburn University Department of Campus Safety & Security immediately. The instructor should also notify the course department head/chair or dean promptly, followed by a memo to the department head/chair or dean.

Extra-Credit

Special extra-credit assignments are never given to individual students, so please do NOT ask for extra assignments or points at the end of the semester (the professor will NOT reply to such emails). The only ways to earn extra points are the two bonus methods described in the “Bonuses” section above, capped at 5% for the semester.

Grading Policy

The student's final grade will be determined by the following scale after rounding his/her total class percentage to the nearest whole percentage point.

Grade Components

Item	Number	Percentage	Total Item Percentage
Unit Exam	3	25%	$(25\% \times 3) = 75\%$
MyEconLab Homeworks	12	2%	$(2\% \times 12) = 24\%$
Syllabus Quiz	1	1%	$(1\% \times 1) = 1\%$
Bonuses	Up to 5		Up to 5%
TOTAL			Up to 105%

Note: The optional final does not add points to your grade; it can only replace unit-exam scores (see "Final Exam Retakes" above).

Grading Scale

A	B	C	D	F
90% & Over	80%–89%	70%–79%	60%–69%	59% & Under

Other Important Dates

- **Unit Exam 1:** Wednesday, September 23, 2026.
- **Unit Exam 2:** Wednesday, October 21, 2026.
- **Unit Exam 3:** Monday, November 30, 2026.
- **Final Exam (Optional Retakes):** Monday, December 7, 2026, 8:00–10:00 a.m.
- If you have a disability and require any special consideration in the administration of exams, then you must inform me by Tuesday, August 25th.
- Please note that October 15th is the last day for a request to move the final.
- Please note that November 20th is the last day for regular withdrawal from the course with no grade penalty.

CELL PHONES (or any other recording devices) ARE NOT PERMITTED DURING CLASSES OR EXAMS (calculations, taking videos, pictures, etc.), unless you are allowed to use them per your disability accommodations.

Weekly Course Calendar (Fall 2026)

Week / Dates (2026)	Chapter / Topic (Principles of Macroeconomics)	Assignment Assigned Date / Syllabus Quiz Due / Exam Dates
Week 1 (Aug 17–21)	Syllabus, course policies. Lecture #1: Economics: Foundation and Models. Lecture #2: Math Review and S&D Review.	
Week 2 (Aug 24–28)	Lecture #2 (cont'd). Lecture #3: GDP.	Syllabus quiz due: end of Week 2 (Fri, Aug 28)
Week 3 (Aug 31–Sep 4)	Lecture #3 (cont'd).	
Week 4 (Sep 7–11)*	Lecture #4: Inflation (CPI).	
Week 5 (Sep 14–18)	Lecture #5: Unemployment.	
Week 6 (Sep 21–25)	Lecture #6: Long-run Economic Growth (Productivity, Growth, Solow Growth Model).	Unit Exam 1: Wed, Sep 23
Week 7 (Sep 28–Oct 2)	Lecture #7: Saving, Investment, and the Financial System. Early Alert Grade deadline — Midsemester.	
Week 8 (Oct 5–9)**	Lecture #8: The AD/AS Model, Money Market.	
Week 9 (Oct 12–16)	Lecture #8 (cont'd).	
Week 10 (Oct 19–23)	Lecture #9: Money Market and the Quantity Theory.	Unit Exam 2: Wed, Oct 21
Week 11 (Oct 26–30)	Lecture #10: Monetary Policy.	
Week 12 (Nov 2–6)	Lecture #10 (cont'd).	
Week 13 (Nov 9–13)	Lecture #11: Fiscal Policy.	
Week 14 (Nov 16–20)	Lecture #12: Budget deficit, fiscal multipliers, etc.	
Week 15 (Nov 23–27)***	Thanksgiving Break — no classes all week.	
Week 16 (Nov 30–Dec 4)	Review.	Unit Exam 3: Mon, Nov 30
Week 17 (Dec 7–11)	Final Exam Week — optional retakes only (no new comprehensive exam).	All homework due: Mon, Dec 7 (midnight). Final Exam (Optional Retakes): Mon, Dec 7, 8:00–10:00 a.m.

* Labor Day is a university holiday. If your section meets Monday, that day has no class.

** Fall Break is Thursday–Friday, October 8–9, 2026.

*** Thanksgiving Break is Monday–Friday, November 23–27, 2026.